CIVIC WISE · ZAMBIA

Civic Education: Facilitator Discussion Guide

Discussion prompts to run alongside the civic courses in a group session.

How to use this guide. Pick one course per session. Have the group work through the lessons on their phones (or read them aloud together), then use these prompts to discuss. There are no wrong answers. The goal is confidence, not a test.

How Government Works

Warm-up

- Name one service you have used in the last month. Which level of government do you think provided it?
- Think of a problem in this community. Who would you go to first, and why?

Go deeper

- What is one right you did not know you had? What is one responsibility you take seriously?
- Share a time you went to the wrong office. What would you do differently now?

Understanding Public Budgets

Warm-up

- List three things in this area that are paid for with public money.
- Where do you think most public money comes from? Discuss before checking the lesson.

Go deeper

- Pick a visible project nearby. As a group, write two specific questions you could ask about its budget and delivery.
- When in the budget cycle can residents give input? How could this group take part next time?

Making a Complaint

Warm-up

- Think of a service that has failed you. Which office should handle it?
- What makes a complaint easy to ignore? What makes one hard to ignore?

Activity

- In pairs, draft a three-sentence complaint about a real local issue. Swap and give one piece of feedback each.
- Walk through the "unresolved problem" scenario together and discuss each choice before revealing the feedback.

Digital Rights and Responsibilities

Warm-up

- What personal information should never be shared in a group chat?
- Have you ever received a message that turned out to be false? How did you find out?

Go deeper

- As a group, agree on three simple rules for a respectful community chat.
- Run the "Should you share it?" scenario and discuss how you would check a message before forwarding.

Civic Wise: free civic and digital skills for communities in Zambia.

Facilitator material · may be printed and shared.